MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps Engineer | CI/CD & Platform Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer transitioning into DevOps and platform engineering, with 7 years of experience and recent hands-on ownership of CI/CD pipelines, ephemeral Kubernetes test environments, observability, and infrastructure tooling. Owns GitLab CI workflows for three product teams and builds Helm-based, short-lived Kubernetes test environments with namespace-level access on a shared cluster; partners with QA and product teams to support feature review and end-to-end testing. Personal infrastructure experience includes a k3s homelab managed with Argo CD and Terraform provisioning for a Hetzner VPS. Documented CI workflows for onboarding and mentored two QA interns. Currently studying for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test-environment deployments), Argo CD, Infrastructure as Code: Terraform (personal Hetzner VPS provisioning)

Monitoring & data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL

Programming & scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, GitLab API

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Systems: Linux, Git, Traefik, cert-manager

Cloud learning: AWS (personal learning: EC2 and S3 basics)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DevOps Engineer | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling workflows, parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end testing into its own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built merge-request ephemeral environments using Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. GitLab CI deploys the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data; environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests against isolated environments.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built Python and PostgreSQL-based collection of CI test results and Grafana dashboards that helped teams identify flaky-test patterns.
- Write Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Documented the CI system for onboarding and mentored two QA interns, helping teams adopt and troubleshoot shared pipeline and test-infrastructure practices.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects through manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal, non-production *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster and deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, with Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS certificate management.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam scheduled for January 2027; currently studying

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)